

were brother and sister because they were so close. In fact, Devin considered himself to be a brother to Rhonda. He looked out for her and became very protective; especially when it came to the men she dated! Rhonda also looked out for Devin, but it was in the area of his finances that she gave Devin the most assistance. In fact, it seemed to her that she was always coming to Devin's financial rescue.

Usually, it was just a couple of bucks to cover a restaurant tab or to get Devin into the movies. Rhonda was sure that these small sums probably added up to quite a sizable amount over the years, but she was happy to help. After all, isn't that the meaning of friendship?

In their senior year in college, Devin got an internship that required him to work two days a week. Devin had never needed a car before since all his classes had been within walking distance. This time, his internship was not nearby and it wasn't possible to get there by public transportation. When Devin went to buy a used car from a dealer, he had no idea that he wouldn't qualify.

Devin had acquired the habit of spending money faster than he made it. It was never really a problem, and Rhonda always was there when he was short of funds. But Rhonda wasn't there when Devin's bills came in the mail. When he didn't have the money, he just ignored the bills. He got letters from time to time telling him he was delinquent, but he usually caught up. There were instances, though, when he didn't pay his debts quickly enough and arrived home to find his phone or utility service disconnected. That also wasn't a problem since Devin always had roommates who could get the service reinstated in their names.

Devin never realized there were consequences from his poor bill-paying record. He learned a hard lesson when the car dealer told him that his credit record was so bad that in order

